AA–B–250a
September 1, 1961

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA–B–250
January 16, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BEDSPRING (PLATFORM-TOP TYPE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a double deck platform-top type bedspring.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Sizes.* The bedsprings shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2).

Size A.—Twin bed.

Size B.—Double bed.

Size C.—Twin bed, extra long.

Size D.—Double bed, extra long.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

V–M–96—Mattresses, Bed, Inner-Spring.
PPP–B–636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL–STD–109—Inspection Terms and Definitions.
MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

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Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Illinois.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of each size of bedspring shall be submitted or made ready for approval of the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests as specified in section 4 to determine compliance with this specification. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification.

3.2 Materials. Materials shall conform to the specifications and requirements specified herein.

3.2.1 *Angles.* Angles shall be of commercial hot-rolled mild steel or of rail carbon steel. Rail carbon steel angles may be used provided that holes for necessary fabrication can be punched therein without fracturing the angles or causing cracks or fissures around the holes or that such angles can be welded or brazed under proper conditions.

3.2.2 *Spring wire.* Spring wire used in the manufacture of the coil and helical springs shall be of hard-drawn steel upholstery-spring wire, knotting and coiling quality. The chemical composition and the tensile strength when tested as specified in 4.4.1 shall be as follows:

(*a*) Chemical composition:

Carbon, 0.45-0.70 percent.

Manganese, 0.70-1.20 percent.

(*b*) Tensile strength:

Diameter	Tensile strength range (p.s.i.)	
(inch)	(minimum)	(maximum)
0.054 to 0.0625 ...	230,000	275,000
0.113	192,000	232,000

3.2.3 *Ink.* Ink shall be any contrasting color and sufficiently water resistant to withstand smearing when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.3 Construction. The assembled bedspring shall conform to the requirements of table I, and shall consist of the following units securely joined together:

(*a*) Frame

(*b*) Cross slats

(*c*) Coils

(*d*) Platform

(*e*) Top border member

(*f*) Top helicals

(*g*) Stabilizers

(*h*) Crimp wire

3.3.1 *Cross slats.* The ends of cross slats specified in 3.4.2 shall be formed prior to assembly by twisting 90 degrees or by edgewise bendings, and offsetting and bending at a suitable angle to provide a lap for joining to the top of the horizontal or vertical flanges of the frame. The joint shall be riveted, welded or brazed. The central portion of the slats shall be perpendicular to the plane of the bed frame and the top shall not be more than 1½ inches below the end offsets. Number of slats required shall be as specified in table I.

3.3.2 *Coils.* Center coils shall be double decked. Side, end, and corner coils shall be inverted cone shaped. The number and arrangement of coils shall be as follows:

Size A—60 coils, arranged 6 rows wide by 10 row long; 66 coils, arranged 6 rows wide by 11 rows long.

Size B—90 coils, arranged 9 rows wide by 10 rows long; 99 coils, arranged 9 rows wide by 11 rows long.

Size C—66 coils, arranged 6 rows wide by 11 rows long; 72 coils, arranged 6 rows wide by 12 rows long.

Size D—99 coils, arranged 9 rows wide by 11 rows long; 108 coils, arranged 8 rows wide by 12 rows long.

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3.3.3 *Final assembly.* Coils shall be securely anchored to the frame by engagement in suitable piercings or notches in conjunction with bottom crimp wires. Coils shall be spaced to provide an approximately equal distribution of the top area. The construction shall be such that a load on any coil will be partially distributed to adjacent coils. The tops of the border coils shall be securely attached to the top border. Helical springs arranged diagonally shall be used to join and maintain the proper relationship between the coils. Center crimp ties or other suitable bracing shall be provided to prevent displacement or distortion of the springs. The assembly shall be free from unnecessary rattle and noise due to adjacent parts rubbing or striking together when any group of springs is partially compressed. Stabilizers shall be located at opposite sides of the bed spring, and shall be securely attached to the top border member and the frame or cross slats.

3.4 Details of components.

3.4.1 *Frame.* The frame shall be fabricated of steel angle conforming to 3.2.1. The angle size shall be 1⅜ inches by 1⅛ inches by 0.12 inch, or 1¼ inches by 1¼ inches by 0.12 inch minimum dimensions, securely riveted, welded or brazed at each joint.

3.4.1.1 *Frame dimensions.* The frame shall be rectangular in shape. The length and width of the frame shall be such as to produce a finished bedspring conforming to dimensions specified in table I. The frame shall have not less than a 3-inch radius at each of the inside corners. The vertical angles shall be on the inside and downstanding.

3.4.2 *Cross slats.* Cross slats shall be fabricated of commercial grade rolled strip or rail carbon steel. The slats shall be 1-inch wide by 0.109 inch thick minimum dimensions.

3.4.3 *Coils.* Coils shall be formed of spring wire specified in 3.2.2. The wire diameter shall be 0.113 inch plus or minus 0.002 inch. Coils shall be stress relieved subsequent to forming. The lower portion of the double deck coils shall be barrel shaped with a closely wound center portion, and the upper portion shall be inverted cone shaped. Coil dimensions shall conform to table II. When tested as specified in 4.4.3 coil shall not decrease in height more than one-eighth of an inch.

3.4.4 *Platform.* The bedspring shall have a top platform support for the mattress. The bands comprising the platform shall be as specified in 3.4.4.1 and shall be suitably shaped and pierced at ends and shaped to allow for attachment by means of helicals longitudinally and laterally to the border row of coils.

3.4.4.1 *Top platform bands.* Top platform bands shall be cold-rolled strip steel not less than 0.020 inch thick. Bands shall be not less than seven-eighths of an inch wide, except when strips having a minimum width of 1⅛ inch are

TABLE I.—*Weights and dimension of assembled bedsprings*

Classification	Number of coils	Minimum number of slats	Weight	Top length	Top width	Width outside to outside of vertical flanges
			Pounds	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
Size A	60	8	54 ± 2	73 ± ¼	37 ± ¼	35⅛ ± ¼
	66	9	57 ± 2	73 ± ¼	37 ± ¼	35⅛ ± ¼
Size B	90	8	71 ± 3	73 ± ¼	52 ± ¼	50⅛ ± ¼
	99	9	75 ± 3	73 ± ¼	52 ± ¼	50⅛ ± ¼
Size C	66	9	59 ± 2	79½ ± ¼	37 ± ¼	35⅛ ± ¼
	72	10	62 ± 2	79½ ± ¼	37 ± ¼	35⅛ ± ¼
Size D	99	9	77 ± 3	79½ ± ¼	52 ± ¼	50⅛ ± ¼
	108	10	81 ± 3	79½ ± ¼	52 ± ¼	50⅛ ± ¼

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TABLE II.—*Coil dimensions*

	Height	Top diameter	Number of convolutions
	Inches	*Inches*	
Center coils, sizes A and C	7 to 7¼	4⅝ to 5⅛	8 to 13
Center coils, sizes B and D	7 to 7¼	4⅜ to 4⅞	8 to 13
Side and end coils	5½ to 5¾	3¾ to 5⅜	6½ to 7
Corner coils	5½ to 5¾	3¾ to 4⅞	6½ to 7

used for longitudinal bands the crossbands may be of a minimum width of five-eighths of an inch.

3.4.5 *Top border member.* Top border member shall be fabricated of steel angle specified in 3.2.1. The angle size shall be ¾ inch by ¾ inch by No. 12 gage (0.109) minimum dimensions for mild steel. For rail steel the minimum flanges thickness dimension shall be No. 13 gage (0.093). The top member shall be rectangular in shape with corner radii and dimensions consistent with the frame as specified in 3.4.1.1. The vertical leg of the angle shall be to the outside and downstanding.

3.4.6 *Top helicals.* Top crossed and band helicals shall be formed of wire specified in 3.2.2 having a diameter of 0.054 to 0.0625 inch. The outside diameter of the helicals, when installed shall be not less than seven-sixteenths of an inch with minimum convolutions per inch of five for crossed helicals and twelve for top band helicals.

3.4.7 *Stabilizers.* Four stabilizing devices suitable to prevent sidesway shall be provided.

3.4.8 *Crimp wire.* Crimp wire shall be hard-drawn low-carbon bright basic wire.

3.5 Finish. All parts of the bedsprings shall be cleaned of all grease, oil, dirt, and loose scale. All parts shall be coated with a baked-on aluminum enamel coating which shall level out to a smooth and uniform film free from runs, wrinkles, drops, or areas of thin or no film. Total dry-film thickness shall be not less than 0.5 mil at any point. A corrosion-resistant prime coat of an enamel of another color will be permitted where more than one coat is required to obtain the minimum thickness. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, there shall be no wrinkling or blistering of the enamel immediately after removal from water. The enamel shall be no more than slightly affected when examined two hours after removal. After 24 hours air drying, the portion of the coil which was immersed shall be indistinguishable from the portion which was not immersed with regard to thumb-nail hardness, color and gloss.

3.6 Identification marking. When specified, (see 6.2), the letters "U.S." in characters 1 inch high, nomenclature, stock number, specification number, the contractor's name or trademark of such known character as to make the source of manufacture easily determined, the contract number and year of contract, all in characters one-fourth of an inch high shall be stamped or stenciled on the frame with water resistant ink specified in 3.2.3.

3.7 Workmanship. Bedsprings shall be clean and free from any defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Inspection responsibility. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Govern-

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ment as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When required, examination and testing of the preproduction sample shall be made of a completely fabricated item for all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests before regular production is started.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in Military Standard MIL–STD–105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. Inspection terms and definitions shall be interpreted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–109.

4.3.1 *Inspection of materials and components.* In accordance with 4.1 the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used are manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.3.2 *In-process inspection.* Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operations or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for aceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements:

Requirement, operation or assembly	Requirement paragraph
Cleaning of surfaces prior to application of aluminum coating	3.5

4.3.3 *Intermediate testing.* Testing of the intermediate product shall be in accordance with table III for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit for testing shall be one inverted cone-shaped coil and one double-deck coil. The AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units for each characteristic. The inspection level shall be L–2 of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

TABLE III.—*Testing of the intermediate product*

Test	Requirement	Test procedure
Compression test ..	3.4.3	4.4.3

4.3.4 *End item examination.*

4.3.4.1 *Examination of the bedsprings.* Examination of the bedsprings shall be in accordance with the classification of defects listed in 4.3.4.1.1 and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) set forth below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bedsprings for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bedspring of each applicable size.

4.3.4.1.1 *Visual characteristics (table IV).*

TABLE IV.—*Visual characteristics*

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish	Not finished as specified	X	
	Evidence of corrosion		X
	Bare spots on wire, angle, band or cross slat not touched-up		X
	Run or sag over 1 inch long on angle, band, or cross slat		X
	Finish on angle, band, or cross slat peeled, blistered, or flaked		X
	Grit, dirt or other foreign matter embedded in the finish of angle, band, or cross slat		X

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TABLE IV.—*Visual Characteristics* (Continued)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Materials (except rivets)	Broken or fractured	X	
	Cracks or fissures at holes in angles	X	
	Dented or damaged to an extent affecting serviceability	X	
	Machine or die marks not affecting serviceability		X
	Malformed or bent out of shape to an extent which may affect serviceability	X	
	Fin, burr or sharp edge which may tear mattress or cause injury	X	
Rivets and riveting (when applicable)	Missing or head broken off	X	
	Missing where required	X	
	Loose or not peened securely		X
Workmanship of welding or brazing	Weld or braze missing where required	X	
	Completely broken or not fused	X	
	Metal burned through at weld		X
	Weld or braze cracked or partially broken		X
	Weld or braze incomplete where continuity is required		X
	Weld or braze undercut		X
Construction and workmanship	Not constructed as specified or not approved design	X	
	Component not design specified		X
	Component missing	X	
	Method of attachment of component not accomplished as specified		X
	Component detached where permanent attachment is required	X	
	Component misaligned or in wrong location		X
	Component loose where secureness is required		X
	Vertical angles not on the inside of the frame and are not downstanding		X
	Angle vertical leg not to the outside of the top border member and not downstanding		X
	Number of cross slats less than specified	X	
	Cross slat not twisted 90 degrees near the ends		X
	Central portion of bed slat not perpendicular to the plane of the bed frame		X
	Coil spring arrangement not as specified or not spaced in a manner permitting equal distribution of the top area		X
	Any coil spring, other than side, end or corner coil not double-deck type		X
	Side, end and corner coil spring not single-deck type		X
	Number of convolutions in any coil not as specified		X
	Top platform support band not pierced at ends to allow for attachment of helicals		X
	Any top platform support band not attached to border row coil spring with helicals		X
	Coil springs not joined with diagonally arranged helical springs		X
	Stabilizers not located at opposite sides of the bedspring		X
	Stabilizers not attached as specified		X
	Assembly not free of unnecessary rattle or noise (check by partially compressing groups of coil springs until every spring on the assembly has been partially compressed at least once)		X
Identification marking	Mising, incorrect, illegible or test incomplete		X
	Wrong location, size of lettering not as specified		X
	Color of marking not as specified		X

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4.3.4.2 *Weight and dimensional examination.* Inspection will be made of bedsprings for compliance with weights and dimensions specified in table I. Any dimension or weight not within the specified tolerance shall constitute a defect.

4.3.4.3 *Testing of the end item.* Testing shall be performed on samples from each inspection lot in accordance with table V. The inspection level for all characteristics shall be L–4 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE V.—*Testing of the end item*

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test Method
Finish	3.5	4.4.4

4.3.4.4 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination will be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking as required by Section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects will be scored as specified herein. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot.

Examination	Defect
Markings	Missing; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective affecting serviceability.
Workmanship ...	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling; bulging or distortion.
Content	Contents per container is more or less than required.

4.3.4.5 *Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels.* The inspection level and acceptable quality levels (AQL's), expressed in defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

For examination in	Inspection level	AQL's	
		Major	Total
4.3.4.1.1	II	2.5	4.0
4.3.4.2	L–4	one class	4.0
4.3.4.3	L–4	one class	4.0
4.3.4.4	L–7	one class	4.0

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Chemical composition and strength test for spring wire.* Specimens of spring wire shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of Federal Test Method Standard No. 151.

4.4.2 *Water-resistance test for ink.* After ink has been applied and dried it shall be wiped with a wet cloth to determine compliance with 3.2.3.

4.4.3 *Coil compression test.* To determine compliance with the requirements of 3.4.3 a fixed load sufficient to compress a spring to a height of not more than 2 inches shall be applied at least 20 successive times one coil.

4.4.4 *Finish test.* Test one coil of the finished spring or a coil that has been finished in the same manner as the springs, using the production finishing equipment and procedure. Air dry the coating for a minimum of 24 hours after baking. Then immerse in distilled water at up to approximately ½ the height of the test coil, at room temperature for 18 hours. At the end of the test period remove and examine for compliance with 3.5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing for civilian procurement.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 *Level A.* Two bedsprings of one size only shall be placed face to face and compressed to not exceed three-fifths of normal thickness of each bedspring and securely tied or wired together.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Bedsprings shall be packaged in accordance with the industry's practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Two bedsprings, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be protected at both ends by a corrugated or solid-fiberboard cap protector completely covering the ends and extending down the top, bottom and sides not less than 9 inches. The fiberboard used shall conform to class 2, V3c or V3s of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. The cap protectors shall be constructed in one piece, scored, and slotted to form a body piece having four flaps for closing over the ends of the bedsprings. When closed, the inner flaps shall not overlap and the outer flaps shall overlap to within 1 inch of the edge. At the joint, one edge of the fiberboard shall overlap the adjoining edge not less than 1¼ inches and shall be stitched. Closure of flaps shall be by stitching with the stitches distributed evenly over the entire area of contact between outer and inner flaps and to prevent lifting of free edges and corners of the outer flaps. Two one-half inch holes shall be perforated at center, one on each side, positioned 1½ inch center from edges. The cap protectors shall be fastened to the bedsprings with not less than 4-ply twine laced through the holes in center edges of the protector and tied to the bedsprings.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Two bedsprings, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except that the corrugated or solid fiberboard used for the cap protectors shall be not less than 200 p.s.i. conforming to type I or II, class 1 of Federal Specification PPP–B–636.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Bedsprings, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order and the precautionary marking specified herein, each unit shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order and the precautionary marking specified herein, each unit shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

5.3.3 *Precautionary marking.* A tag with the following information clearly marked thereon shall be securely attached to each compressed unit in a conspicuous position:

CAUTION

STAND CLEAR WHEN REMOVING TIES

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Sizes A and B bedsprings covered by this specification are intended for use with matresses covered by Federal Specification V–M–96 as follows:

Size A—Bedspring for use with size 7 mattress.

Size B—Bedspring for use with size 12 mattress.

Sizes C and D bedsprings covered by this specification are intended for use by the military only when warranted by special requirements.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number and date of this specification.

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(*b*) Size required (twin bed, double bed, twin bed extra long, double bed extra long) (see 1.2 and 6.1).

(*c*) Whether preproduction samples are waived (see 3.1).

(*d*) Whether identification marking is required (see 3.6).

(*e*) Inspection record details (see 4.1).

(*f*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging, and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Bedsprings, coiled, compressed to not exceeding ⅗ of normal thickness of each bedspring, securely tied.

Carload minimum weights:

In cars 40 feet 9 inches or less in length, inside measurements—10,000; 12,000; 15,000; 18,000; 22,000 and 30,000 pounds.

In cars exceeding 40 feet 9 inches in length, inside measurements—16,000; 18,000; 21,000; 24,000; 30,000 and 40,000 pounds.

Motor:

Bedsprings, coiled, compressed to not exceeding ⅗ of normal thickness of each bedspring, securely tied.

Truckload minimum weights:

(w) 10.6; (w) 12.6; (w) 15.6; (w) 18.6; (w) 22.6 and (w) 30.6 pounds, (w) subject to Rule 34, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—Q
Navy—Y
Air Force—MOA

OTHER INTERESTS:

Navy—MC

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